



Creative Sound Blaster X-Fi Elite Pro

If you're thinking of buying good speakers (like the Klipsch Ultra mentioned later), you better get yourself a good sound card as well. Your onboard sound will just not live up to the capabilities of the speakers.

The first name in sound cards is Creative's Sound Blaster, and the X-Fi Elite Pro is the king of their castle for now. This one boasts of sampling rates of 96 KHz for 7.1 and 192 KHz for stereo audio. The card has 64 MB of X-RAM (sound memory). Think it like graphics card memory, but for sound, so that your system memory is left alone when processing audio!

Output power is 116 dB, and frequency response is <10 Hz to 46 KHz. Apart from the tech-specs, this beauty comes with three preset modes—Audio Creation, Gaming and Entertainment—just pop it into gaming mode and enjoy yourself!

The card is THX-certified, with DTS-ES and Dolby Digital EX decoding, so every movie you watch will be exactly as the director meant it to be—aurally, at least! The best part is that Creative has a very strong presence in India, so getting your hands on this baby will be easy—it costs Rs 15,000 (approx)

Web site: <http://in.creative.com>



Trimersion Head Mounted Display

OK, we'll admit it—this one is just a fun addition, but it will either have your friends in splits or really jealous—it's a 50-50 shot, and is totally your call.

You get a stereo display of 640 x 480, which kind of sucks, but then again, only you'll realise that, because you will be wearing them! The headset features tracking, so you can move your head to turn in the game. The gun will give you controls for both hands, for movement and weapons, while the triggers take care of mouse-work.

Overall, if you have \$395 (Rs 19,000) to throw away, throw it in this direction. Who knows—you might even start to like this unique way of playing shoot-em-ups. Also, if you take this to a LAN party, you're guaranteed to win, because everyone else will be too busy laughing to frag anything!

Web site: www.trimersion.com



The Ultimate Game Chair

Yes, this is a chair, but no ordinary one! This pure leather beauty has 12 feedback motors to enrich your gaming experience, so the chair will shudder when there's an explosion nearby. It's got rear speaker stands that are attached to the chair itself, and controllers attached to the arm rests. These controllers will let you connect to a PC, both Xboxes and both PlayStation models. Get this chair, a small fridge, some one to stock it for you, a bed-pan and a bundle of games, and see how long you can go without getting off this dream chair. Just keep blowing things up to make the force feedback kick in to give you some exercise!

Website: www.ultimategamechair.com